

Prometheus Makes Man

Prometheus and Epimetheus were two of the Titans not to be imprisoned by Zeus. They had fought on the side of the Olympians in the War of the Titans.

Epimetheus decided what every animal should be like.

For their help, Zeus gave them the important job of filling the Earth with life. Prometheus and Epimetheus created all the animals that ran and climbed, from the mightiest elephants to the tiniest ants.

Epimetheus named each species and decided whether it should be strong or fast, clever or dangerous.

Prometheus, however, spent most of his time creating something different—mortal men. He molded them out of water and earth, modeling them in the image of the gods themselves.

When they were done, Zeus looked at Prometheus's prized creations. "Prometheus, in exchange for their lives on Earth, these mortals must give regular gifts to the gods," he ordered.

Prometheus was a mischievous Titan, however. "I don't see why Zeus should have control over my creations," he thought to himself.

